

Week 6: Marriage

JSS1 Christian Religious Studies (CRS) — First Term Lesson Note (Deep-Dive Edition)

Introduction

Marriage is one of the earliest institutions established by God, dating back to the creation of man and woman. This week examines what the Bible teaches about the meaning and functions of marriage.

Meaning of Marriage

Marriage is the union of a man and a woman as husband and wife. This is rooted in Genesis 2:22-25, where God brought the woman to the man, and the Bible states: **“For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and they shall become one flesh”** (Genesis 2:24). Marriage was designed by God to be a permanent, exclusive union.

Functions of Marriage

Based on Ephesians 5:21-31, the functions of marriage include:

Function	Explanation
Companionship	Husband and wife provide love, support, and partnership for one another
Mutual submission and love	Both partners are called to love, respect, and submit to one another (Eph. 5:21)
Representing Christ and the Church	Paul compares the husband-wife relationship to Christ's relationship with the Church (Eph. 5:23-25)
Procreation	Marriage provides the proper context for having and raising children
Building a family unit	Marriage forms the foundation of the family, the basic unit of society

Real-Life Application

The principles of love, respect, and mutual submission taught in marriage also apply to relationships within the wider family and community. Students can practise these values in their own homes by showing respect and consideration toward parents, siblings, and other family members.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
Union	The joining together of two people or things into one
One flesh	A biblical term describing the close, unified bond between husband and wife
Companionship	The state of having a close friend or partner to share life with

Evaluation Questions

- 1 Define marriage, according to Genesis 2:24.
- 2 From which Bible book and chapter do we learn about the functions of marriage?
- 3 List three functions of marriage.
- 4 Explain what “one flesh” means in the context of marriage.
- 5 According to Ephesians 5:21, what is expected of both husband and wife?
- 6 How does Paul compare marriage to the relationship between Christ and the Church?
- 7 Why is marriage considered the foundation of the family?
- 8 In your own words, explain the meaning of companionship in marriage.
- 9 How can the values taught about marriage apply to relationships in your own family?
- 10 Why do you think God designed marriage to be a permanent union?

(Week 7 is Midterm Break — no new content.)